Visualizing Modeled Social Networks: a Provocation *

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Abstract: Network scholarship regularly leverages visualizations. They are thought to enhance readers' recall, interpretation, and understanding of scholars' intended takeaways. However, visualizations combine multiple competing demands that do not readily translate into a single optimal strategy for realizing those benefits. Here, I distinguish between the scientific (1) purposes and (2) principles of network visualization, which are then differentially used across (3) stages of the research process. Drawing on these non-overlapping demands, I encourage the field to consider whether we can improve the utility of visualizations for certain combinations of those aims by presenting *modeled* results in network visualizations.

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